



Daystar University

MAY- AUGUST 2026 Trimester

Theology of Work and Development

THEO 401A

Date: Monday 18th May 2026

Introduction to Theology of Work and Development

Lecture Objectives

- Understand the significance of integrating theology with work and development
- Explore biblical foundations related to work and justice
- Discuss the relevance of theological perspectives in contemporary development practices
- Engage with key questions about faith, work, and social transformation

What is the Theology of Work and Development?

- Theology of Work: How religious beliefs shape our understanding of human work, purpose, and dignity
- Theology of Development: How faith informs approaches to social, economic, and community development
- Intersection: Examining how faith influences development policies and practices

Why Study Theology of Work and Development?

- - To understand the moral and ethical foundations of work
- - To promote justice and human dignity in economic systems
- - To challenge unjust structures through faith-based insights
- - To inspire responsible and compassionate development initiatives

The Biblical Perspective on Work

- - “Creation Mandate:” Genesis 1:28 – Humanity’s role as stewards of creation

Compiled by Rev. Peter Lee (Ph.D)
Faculty, School of Arts and Social Sciences
Department of Theology and Pastoral Studies

- - “Labor and Dignity:” Work as part of God's good creation
- - “Fall and Redemption:” How sin affects work and the hope for restoration
- - “Justice and Jubilee:” Leviticus 25 – principles of economic fairness and community care

Key Biblical Figures and Concepts

- Adam and Eve: Work as participation in God's creative activity
- The Prophets: Justice, fairness, and care for the marginalized
- -Jesus: Vocation, service, and the Kingdom of God
- - **Paul:** Work as a calling and witness

Theological Themes in Work and Development

- Human Dignity: Every person is created in God's image (Imago Dei)
- Justice and Equity: Biblical calls for fairness and care for the oppressed
- Vocation and Calling: Work as a divine calling, not just a means of survival
- Community and Solidarity: Working for the common good

Contemporary Relevance

- How do faith and theology influence modern development practices?
- Addressing global issues: poverty, inequality, environmental sustainability
- Faith-based organizations and their role in development
- Personal and communal responsibility

After Class Group Discussion and Presentation

- How does your faith inform your understanding of work?
- In what ways can theology inspire social justice and development?
- What are the challenges of integrating faith and development work?